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General Comment

While it is undeniable at this point in history that development of AI technology will be ongoing and it is necessary that the United States of America maintain its ability to compete if not lead in this field with other world powers, it absolutely must be done with the protection of the citizen in mind.

AI technology has proven its ability to assist in amazing ways in the fields of medicine, technology, and even entertainment. However it can easily be used by corporations and the government to push the ordinary citizen out of positions that could be deemed unnecessary or redundant in the path of such advances without providing necessary alternatives for those who could be displaced from jobs or even careers.

Intellectual properties must also be considered. Many AI farming sites and technology centers consider it priority to use anything that they can find, regardless of consent, in order to train their AI models to become more powerful. Copyright protections and artistic licenses are an important step to ensure that individual artists, authors, filmmakers and creators do not find their creations taken by AI programs and used without their consent to create derivative works that may blatantly take or even potentially steal from them with no legal recourse to protect their rights as creators. If an individual agrees to allow their creations to be used to train AI or as part of a larger program, then that is of course a transaction up to the artist to engage in. But artists, performers and creators must be given full copyright protections to ensure that AI programs or users of the technology cannot simply take their work because it was posted onto the internet. See Italy's views on the treatment of artists and AI.

The final consideration is the protection of the individual's own appearance. AI technology has the capability of creating accurate deepfakes of people, both visually and auditorily. These AI recreations of people have been used in creative parodies online, but there is an underlying threat that they could be used to falsely incriminate innocent people or even be used to manipulate footage of people to endorse ideals, movements, etc. that the individual does not endorse. These are concerns that have existed since the creation of video and audio technology, but never has the threat of technology being used to weaponize a person's very appearance and sound been so prevalent. It may be considered common sense that a person has the right to their own appearance and voice, but we are on the precipice of a time when even that could come under threat because of the demand for advancing this new, powerful technology.

In closing, AI has the potential to launch humanity into a new age. But we must take steps now to ensure that this new age will be one that enhances the life of the individual, not one that threatens the rights and securities of the people if AI and the people who program it are given unchecked power to do as they please with the technology. If we wait to try and work these protections out after the technology has already been advanced to the point we wish it to be, then it will be far more difficult if not impossible to ensure the protection of the very people those developing these programs desire to help.